

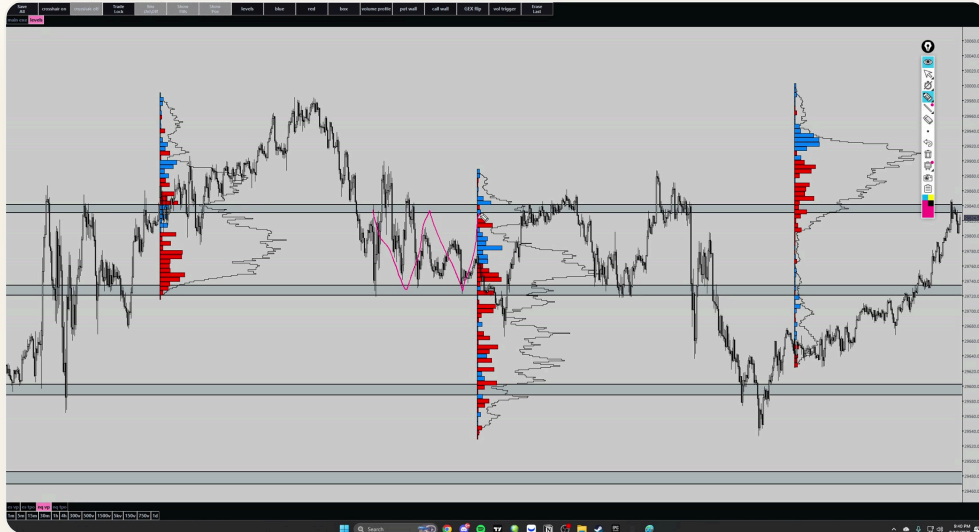
ETHOS ORDER FLOW / EDUCATION



# AMT On Live Markets

*Balance, fair value, acceptance and rejection, read on real charts rather than a diagram*

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AMT • VALUE AREA • LIVE EXAMPLES • 14 PAGES

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## What AMT actually is

### **the market constantly looking for a price both sides agree on**

At its core, AMT is the idea that the market is constantly trying to find a price where buyers and sellers are both willing to do business. Everything else in the framework sits underneath that one sentence.

Price is always in one of two conditions. In balance, both sides are relatively comfortable at current prices, which looks like consolidation, chop, price going nowhere with real conviction. Imbalanced looks like a clean trend, because one side has gotten more aggressive, willing to accept worse and worse prices to keep pushing. Once price moves away from an area both sides had agreed on, participants start looking for the next area of agreement, which is usually a previous one: somewhere price has already done this before.

# 04

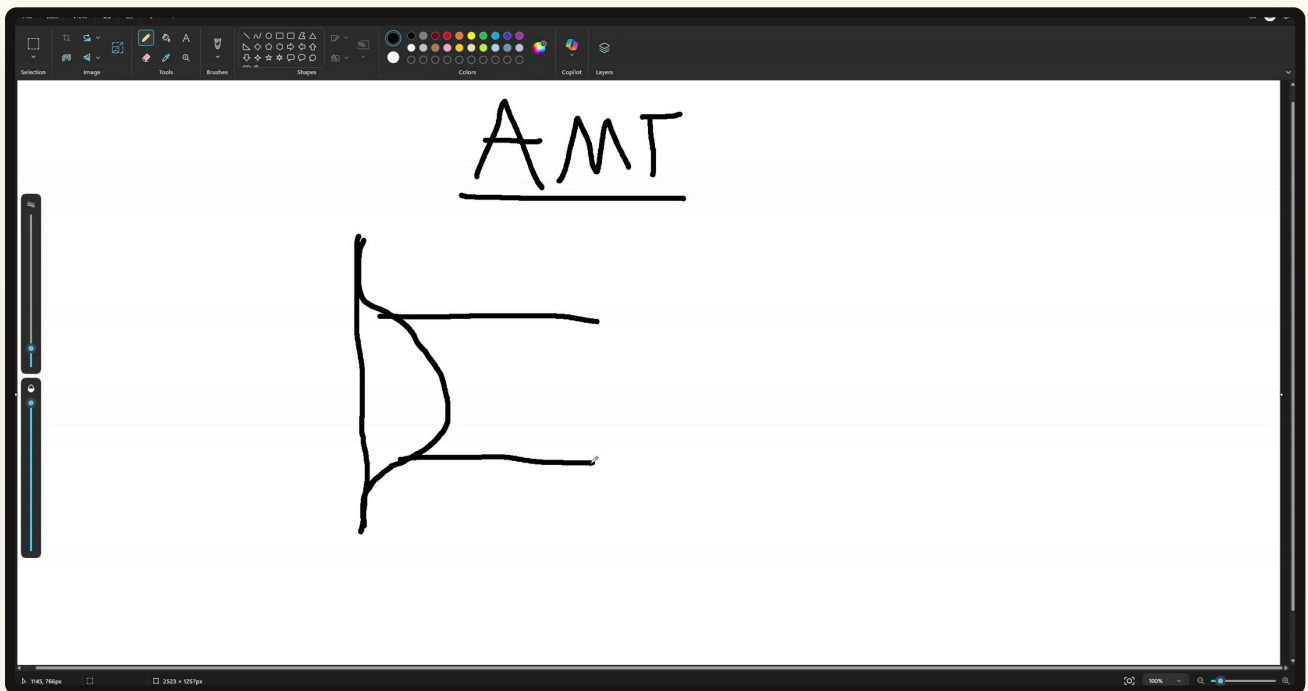
## Fair value and the value area

### not one price, a whole range, and where VAH and VAL come from

Fair value is the area where the market is comfortable doing business, where you see real, significant two sided trade. The correction worth sitting with: fair value is not one exact price point. It's a range.

On a volume profile, that range is the value area, the section of the bell curve containing the majority of a session's traded volume. The top of that range is value area high, the bottom is value area low, and the space between them, where price spends most of its time chopping, is what the rest of AMT is built on top of.

### THE BELL CURVE: VALUE AREA IN THE MIDDLE, THE TAPER AT EACH END



# 05 Extremes

## **the outer edges of the auction, and the one question they force**

Extremes are the same idea as value area, from the other direction: the outer edges of the auction, the taper in volume at each end of the bell curve. When price reaches an extreme, there is exactly one question worth asking: does the market want to keep accepting prices out here, or does it want to reject them and return to fair value.

That question is more useful than it sounds, because it replaces a guess with an observation. You are not predicting what price will do at the extreme. You are watching what it actually does once it gets there, and reading that.

## Acceptance and rejection

### **the actual lens AMT gives you, not "buy or sell here"**

This is the most important pair of concepts in AMT, and the reframe is worth stating exactly the way he puts it: instead of thinking "price touched this level, so should I buy or sell," think "what did the auction do after reaching this level. Did we accept into the range, or did we reject."

Acceptance means the market is comfortable doing business at those prices. It looks like price spending time there and building structure, chopping around a level rather than fleeing it.

Rejection is the opposite: price enters an area and quickly moves away from it. If fair value was established lower and price rejects an upper extreme, the read is straightforward: sellers failed to drive price lower there, buyers absorbed them, and price rejected back up. The level told you what happened. You didn't have to guess.

# High volume nodes and low volume nodes

## where price stalls, and where it has no reason to

Inside a volume profile you'll often see more than one bell curve stacked together, what he calls a double distribution. A high volume node is exactly what it sounds like, an area where a lot of volume traded, usually because price spent real time there. A low volume node is the opposite, a stretch with relatively little trading, typically left behind by a fast move up or down.

Low volume nodes represent a lack of acceptance, and they tend to exist between two areas of established value. When price enters one, the same acceptance-or-rejection question applies: does price reject immediately on contact, or does it just keep going, dumping straight through because there was never much conviction there to begin with.

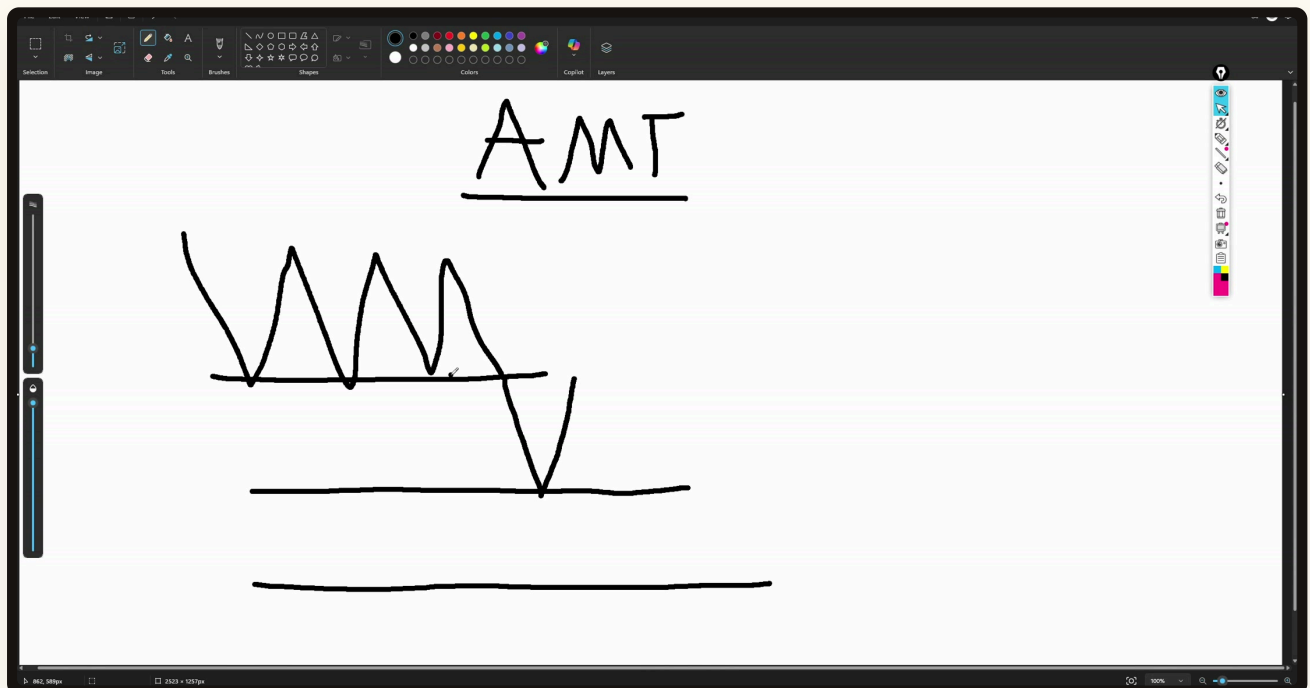
# The failed auction

## drawn from scratch: what failing to find fair value actually looks like

Put the balance-imbalance-balance cycle and the acceptance question together and you get the failed auction. Price is at fair value, sellers gain control, and price gets driven lower, back toward a previous area of fair value. If price reaches that lower area and rejects it, coming all the way back up rather than accepting into it, that's a failed auction: the market failed to find fair value at the lower prices it just tried.

Once price comes back into the original range, the same acceptance question is waiting again, one level up. That's the setup for the odds discussed next.

## THE FAILED AUCTION, DRAWN STEP BY STEP: DRIVEN LOWER, REJECTED, BACK INTO RANGE







# The 80/20 odds, and how POC tells you which one

## repeated failure at POC is the tell, not a guess

Once price is back inside the previous range after a failed auction, he assigns rough odds to what happens next: 80 percent that price runs all the way to the far extreme, 20 percent that it simply ranges inside instead. The number itself matters less than the tool he uses to tell which one you're actually in before it resolves.

Inside that balance there is a POC. If price keeps coming in and constantly fails to break through it and hold, that's a clear sign you're most likely getting the 20 percent case, a session that just chops inside fair value. But if buyers push aggressively through POC, maybe with a retest that holds, that's the tell you're more likely seeing the 80 percent case play out.

Reading which side of the 80/20 you're actually in, live, is what gets walked through every session inside the mentorship.

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# Live example: rejection, a retest, and the trip back to previous balance

## **a deep dip that still failed to hold**

On the chart, price had been going from one extreme to the other inside a defined balance. Once it finally rejected and continued lower, a small retest confirmed the move, and the target became the previous balance further down, an area where price had already agreed on value once before.

What makes this example worth including rather than a cleaner one: price didn't just tag that lower level and bounce. It dipped meaningfully into the previous balance, deep enough that a less patient read might have called it accepted. It still failed to actually hold and trade lower from inside it. Buyers slowly gained momentum and eventually pushed price all the way back up into the newer, higher balance. The rejection was real, it just took longer to confirm than the textbook version does.

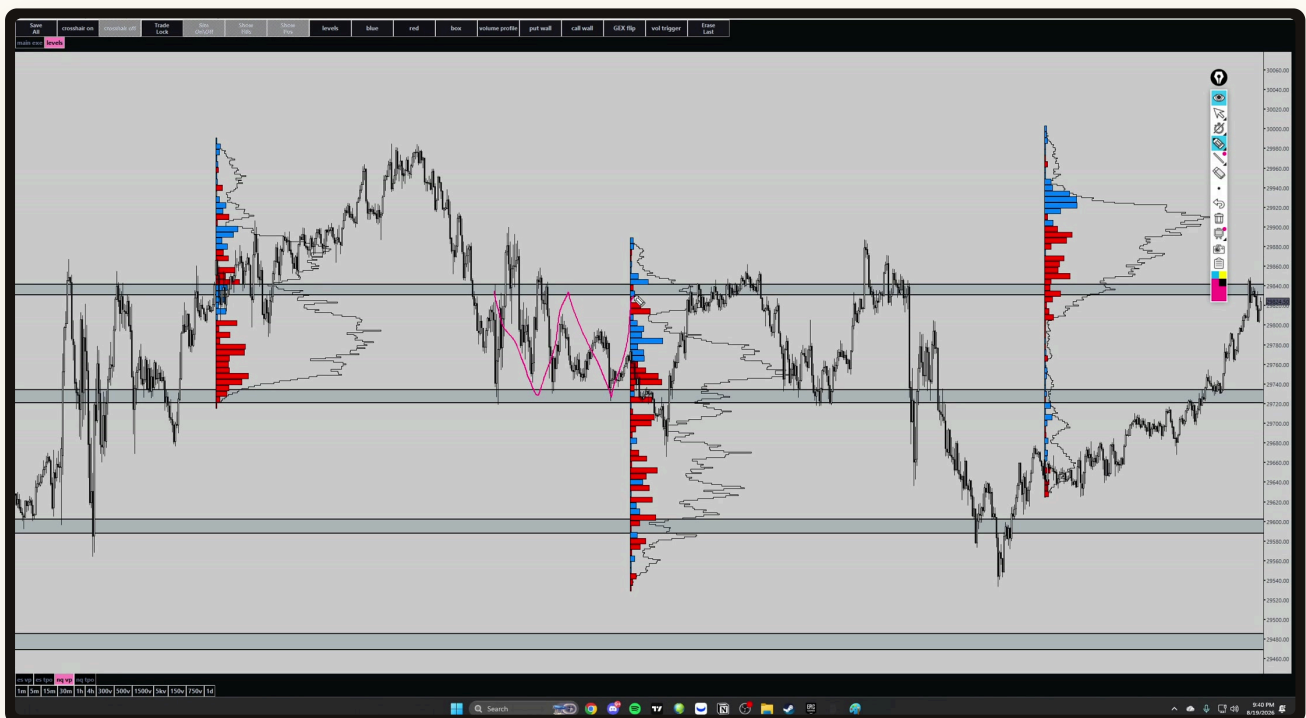
# Live example: a week long balance, read on the higher timeframe

## extreme to extreme, then a clean break away from it

The second example zooms all the way out. Price had auctioned inside one balance for around a week, moving from extreme to extreme to extreme, repeatedly accepting the same range as fair value each time it returned to it.

Once price finally broke out, a new fair value formed above the old range, and price traded inside it only briefly before showing it no longer wanted to participate there either. It broke out again, got a small retest, and came all the way back down to the original fair value, this time not stopping to trade inside it. Instead of building structure there the way it had for a week, price simply dumped straight through and is now holding at the lower extreme instead, the low volume node behavior from earlier in the document, on the highest timeframe in this whole document.

## A WEEK LONG BALANCE: EXTREME TO EXTREME, THEN A BREAK THAT DIDN'T LOOK BACK



# The one question underneath all of it

## **where is the market finding acceptance, and where is it rejecting price**

Every concept in this document, balance, fair value, extremes, high and low volume nodes, the failed auction, the 80/20 read, exists to answer a single question: where is the market finding acceptance, and where is it rejecting price. That's the actual foundation of auction market theory, not a specific setup.

Once that question becomes the lens you look through by default, the setups in this document stop being separate tricks to memorize and start looking like the same read, applied at whatever level price happens to be testing right now.

# The checklist

## every rule in this document, printable

### READING BALANCE AND VALUE

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- ☐ I know whether price is currently in balance or imbalanced.
- ☐ I'm treating fair value as a range (VAH to VAL), not a single price.

### AT THE EXTREME

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- ☐ I'm asking "did the auction accept or reject here," not "should I buy or sell here."
- ☐ A deep dip into a level isn't automatically acceptance. I've confirmed it actually held and traded there.

### HIGH AND LOW VOLUME NODES

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- ☐ I know whether the level in play is a high volume node (expect a stall) or a low volume node (expect a slice through).

### THE 80/20 READ

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- ☐ I'm checking POC behavior rather than defaulting to the 80% case.
- ☐ I can point to repeated failure to hold above or below POC before assuming who's in control.

# One question. Acceptance, or rejection.

Nothing in this document is a promise about what a trial gets you specifically. It's one teacher's real framework, applied to two live sessions at very different timeframes: a deep dip that still rejected, and a week long balance that finally let go. Same question both times.

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Live sessions, daily, where this framework gets applied to the actual open.

*Companion reading: Who's In Control, and Trapped Buyers, One Retest, both free at [kanji.org.uk](https://kanji.org.uk).*

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